

original wording in some line of transmission other than **f**³⁵, would that transmission be any less careful than what I have demonstrated for **f**³⁵? I think not. So any line of transmission characterized by internal confusion is disqualified—this includes all the other lines of transmission that I have seen so far!¹

On the basis of the evidence so far available I affirm the following:

1. The original wording was never ‘lost’, and its transmission down through the years was basically normal, being recognized as inspired material from the beginning.
2. That normal process resulted in lines of transmission.
3. To delineate such lines, MSS must be grouped empirically on the basis of a shared mosaic of readings.
4. Such groups or families must be evaluated for independence and credibility.
5. The largest clearly defined group is Family 35.
6. Family 35 is demonstrably independent of all other lines of transmission throughout the NT.
7. Family 35 is demonstrably ancient, dating to the 3rd century, at least.²
8. Family 35 representatives come from all over the Mediterranean area; the geographical distribution is all but total.³
9. Family 35 is not a recension, was not created at some point subsequent to the Autographs.
10. Family 35 is an objectively/empirically defined entity throughout the NT; it has a demonstrable, diagnostic profile from Matthew 1:1 to Revelation 22:21.
11. The archetypal form of Family 35 is demonstrable—it has been demonstrated (see the “Profile” in Part II above).
12. The Original Text is the ultimate archetype; any candidate must also

¹ Things like **M**⁶ and **M**⁵ in John 7:53-8:11 come to mind.

² Family 35 readings are attested by early witnesses, but without pattern, and therefore without dependency. But there are many hundreds of such readings. So how did the **f**³⁵ archetype come by all those early readings? Did its creator travel around and collect a few readings from Aleph, a few from B, a few from P^{45,66,75}, a few from W and D, etc.? Is not such a suggestion patently ridiculous? The only reasonable conclusion is that the **f**³⁵ text is ancient (also independent).

³ And for some places in Greece, based on their surviving copies, it was all they used.